

Lithobates catesbeianus

American bullfrog



Length 3½–8 in (9–20 cm)
Habit Mostly aquatic
Breeding Spring season
Status Least concern

Location S.E. Canada, W., C., and E. USA. Introduced to Europe, South America, and E. Asia



Renowned for its voracious appetite, the American bullfrog is the largest frog in America. It lives in lakes, ponds, and slow-flowing streams, spending most of its life in water or close to it. In some parts of its range it is plain green above, while in others it is boldly patterned. During the breeding season—in spring and summer—males defend their territories, and produce a deep, sonorous call from a vocal sac under their throats. After mating, females lay several thousand eggs. Their tadpoles can take up to 4 years to become adult.

AMPHIBIAN INVADER



The American bullfrog has a varied diet, including mammals, reptiles, and other frogs. Originally from eastern North America, it has been introduced into several regions farther west, where it has had a harmful effect on local freshwater wildlife.

PHYSICAL APPEARANCE

The most prominent features of this large frog are its long, powerful hind limbs and prominent eardrums. It is green above, with brown markings, and white below.

large eardrums

brown markings

*Rana dalmatina*

Agile frog



Length 2–3½ in (5–9 cm)
Habit Mostly terrestrial
Breeding Spring season
Status Least concern

Location N., C., and S. Europe



With its exceptionally long hind legs, the agile frog is a remarkable jumper, capable of leaping several yards. It is pale brown, with brown-striped yellow flanks, and has dark brown spots on its back that are usually arranged in an inverted “V” pattern. Males can be distinguished from females

by their thicker forelimbs. This frog inhabits open woodland and swampy meadows, spending winter and dry periods under logs and rocks, or buried under vegetation, although males often overwinter under ice in ponds and lakes. They breed as soon as the ice begins to melt in spring, and the eggs are laid in clumps in water.

very long hind limbs

pointed snout

*Lithobates sylvaticus*

Wood frog



Length 1½–3¼ in (3.5–8 cm)
Habit Mostly terrestrial
Breeding Spring season
Status Least concern

Location Canada, E. USA



Although the wood frog is usually found in temperate woodland in the southern part of its range, it can survive well into the arctic circle, farther north than any other frog in North America. Its blood contains chemicals that act as an “antifreeze,” enabling it to live in subzero

temperatures. It often breeds while the snow is still on the ground and the breeding ponds are partially frozen. The wood frog varies in color from pink through various shades of brown to black, with darker markings. It has stripes on its legs and a characteristic dark patch, called the “robber’s mask,” behind its eyes.

*Pelophylax ridibundus*

Marsh frog



Length 3½–6 in (9–15 cm)
Habit Mostly aquatic
Breeding Spring season
Status Least concern

Location Europe, W. and S.W. Asia

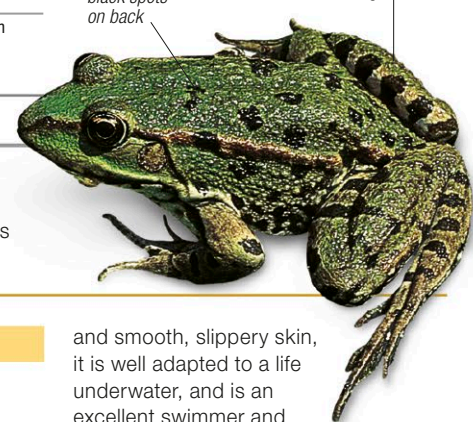


Europe’s largest frog, this brown or green species has typically long, powerful hind legs, longitudinal folds of skin on its back, and close-set

eyes. An inhabitant of lakes, ponds, ditches, and streams, the marsh frog feeds on fish, lizards, snakes, mice, and other frogs, as well as on insects and other invertebrates. Females lay up to 12,000 eggs in water.

black spots on back

black bands on legs

*Conraua goliath*

Goliath bullfrog



Length 4–16 in (10–40 cm)
Habit Mostly aquatic
Breeding Rainy season
Status Endangered

Location Cameroon, Equatorial Guinea



Found exclusively in West Africa, this is the world’s largest frog. With its powerful hind limbs, long, webbed toes,

and smooth, slippery skin, it is well adapted to a life underwater, and is an excellent swimmer and diver. The tips of its toes are dilated, but the function of this feature is not known. The goliath bullfrog lives along streams in jungles, and feeds on other frogs, small reptiles, and mammals. It rarely emerges on land, but when it does it is quick to dive back into water whenever threatened or disturbed. Unusually among frogs, the male of this species is larger than the female and does not call to attract mates. Little is known about the breeding habits of the goliath bullfrog.

